AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Academy

Cybersecurity Learning Resources & Career Paths

24	149,927	38%	7
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

24 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-22** (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

Structured learning: curricula, roadmaps and free course catalogs. We favor maintained, community-trusted material over link farms; archived classics stay listed when they remain the reference everyone cites.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-22)

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 4 of 9 tracked GitHub repos (44%)
- **Quiet classics (no push in 12+ months, still listed):** Infosec Reference, SecuriBench Micro
- **Earliest entries:** Android Security Awesome (2014), Infosec Reference (2014), SecuriBench Micro (2014)

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — 519 curated free tools across 14 realms

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
PayloadsAllTheThings	82k	2016	2026-08-27	A list of useful payloads and bypass for Web Application Security and Pentest/CTF
GTFOBins	13.8k	2018	2026-05-27	GTFOBins is a curated list of Unix-like executables that can be used to bypass local security restrictions in...
OWASP MSTG	13.3k	2016	2026-10-16 ✓	The OWASP Mobile Application Security Testing Guide (MASTG) is a comprehensive manual for mobile app security...
HackTricks	12.6k	2020	2026-10-22 ✓	Welcome to the page where you will find each trick/technique/whatever I have learnt in CTFs, real life apps, a...
Android Security Awesome	9.8k	2014	2026-10-19 ✓	A collection of android security related resources
PayloadsAllTheThings	82k	2016	2026-08-27	— the curated payload and methodology repo — copy, paste, understand, learn. Used by pentesters grabbing working payloads fast; the community cookbook for every attack class.

FULL INVENTORY — 24 CURATED TOOLS

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-22 census · non-GitHub tools listed without stars

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
PayloadsAllTheThings	82k	2016	2026-08-27	— the curated payload and methodology repo — copy, paste, understand, learn. Used by pentesters grabbing working payloads fast; the community cookbook for every attack class.
GTFOBins	13.8k	2018	2026-05-27	— the living Linux binary-abuse matrix; the privilege-escalation bible. Used by pentesters finding Unix binary-abuse paths for privesc; the standard free lookup red teams quote. (GPL-3.0)

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
OWASP MSTG	13.3k	2016	2026-10-16 ✓	— the Mobile Security Testing Guide: the canonical methodology for mobile app assessments. Used by mobile security testers following the standard methodology; the OWASP mobile testing guide commercial mobile audits follow. (CC-BY-SA-4.0)
HackTricks	12.6k	2020	2026-10-22 ✓	— the pentester's playbook: technique-by-technique attack references from recon to post-exploitation. Used by pentesters as the encyclopedic reference during engagements; the donation-supported playbook the community keeps current. (free; custom content license)
Android Security Awesome	9.8k	2014	2026-10-19 ✓	— curated Android security research: tools, papers and training. Used by mobile security researchers assembling toolkits. (Apache-2.0, curated list)
LOLBAS	8.9k	2018	2026-09-26 ✓	— the Windows counterpart to GTFOBins: living-off-the-land binaries and scripts. Used by red teamers planning fileless attacks and defenders writing detections for them. (GPL-3.0)
Infosec Reference	6k	2014	2025-10-20	— the giant information-security reference: tools, papers and guides in one place. Used by learners and practitioners organizing knowledge; vendor-marketing-free. (curated list)
Network Segmentation Cheat Sheets	3.5k	2021	2026-02-02	— practical segmentation architecture: VLANs, zones and rules that survive audits. Used by network architects designing defensible segmentation; the free practical reference. (Apache-2.0)
SecuriBench Micro	27	2014	2018-07-26	— the Stanford benchmark suite for security-analysis tools. Used by academic researchers benchmarking static analysis; Stanford's free test suite for tool evaluation. (Apache-2.0)
Bug Bounty Hunter	—	—	—	— free bug-bounty training platform: real methodology and lab targets. Used by aspiring hunters learning methodology; the free resource for bounty skill-building. (free service)
CTF Field Guide	—	—	—	— Trail of Bits' field guide to capture-the-flag: from fundamentals to finals. Used by CTF newcomers learning the game; the free guide from the CTF community. (CC-BY-4.0)
Cyber Security Base	—	—	—	— free course series by Aalto University and F-Secure; from beginner to blue team. Used by students taking university-level security courses; the free MOOC series from F-Secure and Helsinki. (free course)
Hacker101	—	—	—	— HackerOne's free web-security course: video lessons plus an always-on CTF for bug-bounty practice. Used by aspiring bounty hunters starting on HackerOne; the free training with bounties attached.
Hacksplaining	—	—	—	— interactive security lessons for developers: exploit each vulnerability class, then patch it yourself. Used by developers learning web vulns interactively; the free lesson series engineering teams assign.
IppSec	—	—	—	— the legendary HTB walkthrough archive; watch a master work through every box, searchable by technique. Used by HTB learners studying full walkthroughs; the free video walkthroughs that taught a generation of pentesters.
LiveOverflow	—	—	—	— deep-dive security videos that explain *why* things break — the channel every hacker watched. Used by learners building deep intuition for exploitation; the free video series on hacking fundamentals.
OWASP API Security Project	—	—	—	— the API Top 10 and testing methodology: the standard reference for assessing API authentication, authorization and abuse cases. Used by API auditors mapping coverage against the canonical API risk list; the free OWASP guide every API assessment references. (CC BY-SA)
OWASP Cheat Sheet Series	—	—	—	— concise, developer-friendly defensive guidance per topic; the fix side of every finding. Used by developers building defenses correctly; the free OWASP guidance engineers link in code reviews.

TOOL	★STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
OWASP WSTG	—	—	—	— the Web Security Testing Guide — the methodology standard for thorough assessments. Used by auditors and pentesters as the canonical assessment methodology; the free OWASP guide commercial audits map to.
PortSwigger Web Security Academy	—	—	—	— free, best-in-class web-hacking labs from the Burp Suite team; the standard web-security curriculum. Used by aspiring bug bounty hunters and web pentesters; the free training platform from the Burp Suite makers that rivals paid courses.
Professor Messer	—	—	—	— free complete video courses for Security+, Network+ and CySA+; the default free cert-prep resource. Used by certification students as the default free alternative to paid bootcamps.
pwn.college	—	—	—	— ASU's free hands-on curriculum from Linux basics to kernel exploitation, with dojo challenges. Used by students mastering binary exploitation; Arizona State's free curriculum from basics to kernel pwn.
Roppers Academy	—	—	—	— free structured courses from computing fundamentals to security — the patient beginner's path. Used by beginners building computing and security fundamentals; the free structured coursework.
SEED Labs	—	—	—	— the university-grade lab curriculum: hundreds of hands-on exercises for every security course topic. Used by university courses teaching hands-on security; the free open labs adopted by hundreds of classes.